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Lit tools and power storage

Abstract

An assemblage for use with a vacuum having a conduit. The assemblage includes a light assembly including a housing and a generator having a fan rotor. The generator generates an electrical current in response to the fan rotor turning. The generator is positioned in the housing to move air across the fan rotor. The light assembly includes a circuit operatively connected to the generator and a light emitting device. The circuit energizes the light emitting device to emit light energy in response to receiving the electrical current from the generator. The light assembly also includes a lens aligned with the light emitting device for concentrating the light energy. The assemblage includes a tool assembly including a light transmitting body mounted adjacent to the lens. The tool assembly includes a cover surrounding the light transmitting body to prevent light energy from being emitted through the cover.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation-in-part of co-pending U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/631,857 entitled, “LIT TOOLS AND POWER STORAGE” filed on Apr. 10, 2024, which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Vacuums have been in use for more than 100 years and are common in residences and commercial properties. Over time, vacuums have been modified to attract consumer attention to increase sales and meet consumer needs. Currently, more than 25 major manufacturers sell vacuums in the United States. In this competitive market, consumers are attracted to vacuums by price, features, and convenience. Existing vacuums have a range of features including attachments such as crevice tools, brushes, floor tools, and wands that help users during cleaning.

(2) Crevice tools are used to clear debris from small areas such as between couch cushions, under furniture and appliances, and beside appliances. Current crevice tools work well in narrow spaces, but those spaces are usually not well lit. When spaces are not lit, users cannot see what the vacuum

is picking up and may not know when the space is free of debris.

(3) Brushes are used to clean shelves, pictures, computers, blinds, and delicate items. Many shelves are not directly lit, making it difficult to see what the tool is contacting and picking up. Because items on shelves may be fragile, it is important the user be aware of where the brush is in relation to the items. The usefulness of current brushes is limited because they do not offer the ability to illuminate the area being cleaned.

(4) As the popularity of hardwood floors increases, vacuum manufacturers offer more vacuum attachments for bare cleaning bare floors. These tools are intended to pick up debris such as sand and cereal crumbs from bare floors, which can be difficult. Some vacuums tend to push granular debris around. Worse, some roller brushes scatter the debris rather than picking it up. Like other tools or attachments, hardwood floor tools are sometimes used in dimly lit areas such as beneath tables, making it difficult for users to see whether debris is picked up. In addition to being less helpful to users, low light areas slow users down because additional passes may be needed to ensure the area is clean.

(5) Some high-end residential vacuums offer lit tools that are powered by electrified hoses and couplers. The added complexity needed to deliver electricity to the tools through hoses and couplers increases the cost of these vacuums. Thus, most residential vacuums do not have lit tools, and it is believed no commercial vacuums offer lit tools. Thus, there is a need for a simpler and more economical way to power lit tools for residential and commercial vacuums.

SUMMARY

(6) In one aspect, the present disclosure includes an assemblage for use with a vacuum to remove dust and debris from a selected surface by drawing air through an interior passage of a conduit. The conduit has a length extending from a vacuum end to a tool end opposite the vacuum end. The assemblage comprises a light assembly capable of connecting to the tool end of the conduit. The light assembly includes a housing having a hollow interior in fluid communication with the interior passage of the conduit when the light assembly is connected to the tool end of the conduit. The light assembly also includes a generator having a fan rotor. The generator generates an electrical current in response to the fan rotor turning. The generator is positioned in the housing to move air across the fan rotor thereby turning the fan rotor, so the generator generates the electrical current when air is being drawn through the housing and the interior passage of the conduit. Further, the light assembly includes a circuit positioned in the housing operatively connected to the generator and a light emitting device. The circuit energizes the light emitting device to emit light energy in response to receiving the electrical current from the generator. The light assembly also includes a lens mounted in the housing and aligned with the light emitting device for concentrating the light energy emitted by the light. In addition, the assemblage comprises a tool assembly adapted to connect to the light assembly housing. The tool assembly has an interior passageway extending from a downstream port in fluid communication with the hollow interior of the housing when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly housing to an upstream opening through which air is drawn when removing dust and debris from the selected surface. The tool assembly includes a light transmitting body having an input surface and a light emitting tip opposite the input end. The input surface is mounted adjacent to the lens when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly so light energy concentrated by the lens enters the light transmitting body through the input surface and is transmitted through the body to the light emitting tip. The tool assembly also includes a cover surrounding the light transmitting body to prevent light energy transmitted through the light transmitting body from being emitted through the cover.

(7) In another aspect, the present disclosure includes an assemblage for use with a vacuum to remove dust and debris from a selected surface by drawing air through an interior passage of a flexible hose. The flexible hose has a length extending from a vacuum end to a tool end opposite the vacuum end. The assemblage comprises a light assembly capable of connecting to the tool end of the flexible hose. The light assembly includes a housing having a hollow interior in fluid

communication with the interior passage of the flexible hose when the light assembly is connected to the tool end of the flexible hose. The light assembly also includes a generator having a fan rotor. The generator generates an electrical current in response to the fan rotor turning. The fan rotor is aligned with an opening in the housing across the fan rotor thereby turning the fan rotor, so the generator generates the electrical current when air is being drawn through the housing and the interior passage of the flexible hose. In addition, the light assembly includes a circuit positioned in the housing operatively connected to the generator and a light emitting device. The circuit energizes the light emitting device to emit light energy in response to receiving the electrical current from the generator. Further, the light assembly includes a lens mounted in the housing and aligned with the light emitting device for concentrating the light energy emitted by the light on an output surface of the lens. The assemblage also comprises a tool assembly adapted to connect to the light assembly housing. The tool assembly has an interior passageway extending from a downstream port in fluid communication with the hollow interior of the housing when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly housing to an upstream opening through which air is drawn when removing dust and debris from the selected surface. The tool assembly includes a light transmitting body having a tubular section defining at least a portion of the interior passageway. The light transmitting body has an input surface mounted adjacent to the output surface of the lens when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly so light energy passes from the output surface of the lens to the input surface of the light transmitting body and is transmitted through the tubular section of the light transmitting body. The tool assembly also comprises a cover surrounding the light transmitting body assembly to prevent light energy transmitted through the light transmitting body from being emitted through the cover. The cover has a shaped opening to allow light energy to be emitted through the shaped opening.

(8) In yet another aspect, the present disclosure includes an assemblage for use with a vacuum to remove dust and debris from a selected surface by drawing air through an interior passage of a flexible hose. The flexible hose has a length extending from a vacuum end to a tool end opposite the vacuum end. The assemblage comprises a light assembly capable of connecting to the tool end of the flexible hose. The light assembly includes a housing having a hollow interior in fluid communication with the interior passage of the flexible hose when the light assembly is connected to the tool end of the flexible hose. The housing includes an orifice extending from outside the housing to the hollow interior. The light assembly also includes a generator having a fan rotor. The generator generates an electrical current in response to the fan rotor turning. The fan rotor is in fluid communication with the orifice in the housing to move air across the fan rotor when air is being drawn through the housing, so the fan rotor rotates causing the generator to generate the electrical current. In addition, the light assembly includes an annular printed circuit board having a central opening and a plurality of light emitting diodes spaced around the central opening. The printed circuit board is positioned in the housing and operatively connected to the generator and the plurality of light emitting diodes to energize the plurality of light emitting diodes to emit light energy in response to receiving the electrical current from the generator. Further, the light assembly includes a series of lenses mounted in the housing. Each lens of the series of lenses has a central aperture aligned with the central opening in the printed circuit board, so light energy emitted by the plurality of light emitting diodes is concentrated by the series of lenses on an output surface of said series of lenses. The assemblage also comprises a tool assembly adapted to connect to the light assembly housing. The tool assembly has an interior passageway extending from a downstream port in fluid communication with the hollow interior of the housing when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly housing to an upstream opening through which air is drawn when removing dust and debris from the selected surface. The tool assembly includes a light transmitting body having an input surface and a light emitting tip opposite the input end. The input surface is mounted adjacent to the output surface of the series of lenses when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly so light energy concentrated by the series of lenses enters the light transmitting

body through the input surface and is transmitted through the body to the light emitting tip. The tool assembly also includes a cover surrounding the light transmitting body to prevent light energy transmitted through the light transmitting body from being emitted through the cover.

(9) Other aspects of the present disclosure will be apparent in view of the following description and claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) The present disclosure includes non-limiting examples illustrated in the accompanying drawings.

(2) FIG. 1 is a first fragmentary perspective of an example of a lit tool assemblage for use with a vacuum cleaner;

(3) FIG. 2 is a second fragmentary perspective of the example of FIG. 1;

(4) FIG. 3 is a first separated fragmentary perspective of the example;

(5) FIG. 4 is a second separated fragmentary perspective of the example; and

(6) FIG. 5 is a cross section of a lens assembly of the lit tool assemblage.

(7) Corresponding reference characters indicate corresponding parts throughout the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Referring to the drawings and in particular FIGS. 1 and 2, a lighted or lit tool assemblage of a vacuum cleaner or vacuum is designated in its entirety by reference number **10**. The lit tool assemblage **10** generally comprises a hose assembly (generally designated by **12**), a self-powered light assembly (generally designated by **14**), and a lighted or lit tool assembly (generally designated by **16**). The hose assembly **12** is operatively connected to a conventional vacuum cleaner (not shown) that pulls air through the tool assembly **16** and light assembly **14** to pick up dust and debris and pull it into a collection bag or canister (not shown) where the dust and debris are held for subsequent disposal. As will be explained in more detail, the self-powered light assembly **14** generates electricity using a small amount of air (e.g., less than five cubic feet per minute) pulled through the assemblage **10** by the vacuum. The self-powered light assembly **14** uses the generated electricity to produce light that is transmitted to the lit tool assembly **16**. The light is emitted from the lit tool assembly **16** to illuminate adjacent surfaces to aid users in directing the tool assembly to surfaces having dust and debris.

(9) As shown in FIGS. 3 and 4, the hose assembly **12** comprises a flexible hose, or more broadly a conduit, generally designated by **20**, having a length (partially shown) extending between a vacuum end (not shown) and a tool end **22**, as well as a connector assembly, generally designated by **24**, for joining the hose assembly to the self-powered light assembly **14**. Although the conduit **20** is referred to as a flexible hose throughout this description, it should be understood the conduit may include a rigid tube (i.e., a wand attachment). Further, it is envisioned the conduit may take the form of an adaptor for retrofitting a preexisting vacuum hose or wand attachment. The connector assembly **24**, is adapted to releasably connect the light assembly **14** to the hose assembly **12**. The connector assembly **24** includes a collar **30** having opposed cantilevered detent clips **32** configured to releasably attach the collar to the light assembly **14**. The connector assembly **24** also includes a tubular fitting, generally designated by **34**, that is attached to the tool end **22** of the hose **20**. In the illustrated example, threads or circumferential ridges **36** are formed on an inner surface of the fitting **34**. These ridges **36** are configured to engage corresponding ridges **38** on an exterior surface of the hose **20**. In one example, the interlocking ridges **36**, **38** on the fitting **34** and hose **20** are bonded together with an adhesive to prevent the fitting from turning independently with respect to the hose. It is envisioned that the fitting **34** and hose **20** may be joined using other methods including by providing them with a modest interference fit. A seat **40** is provided on an end of the

fitting **34** for receiving a seal ring **42** to pneumatically seal an interface between the hose assembly **12** and the light assembly **14** as will be explained.

(10) As further shown in FIGS. **3** and **4**, the light assembly **14** includes an upper housing shell **50** and a lower housing shell **52** that are joined to form a housing, generally designated by **54** (FIGS. **1** and **2**). Although the shells **50**, **52** may be joined using other conventional methods, such as using adhesives, screw fasteners, or snap connectors, the illustrated shells are joined by sonic welding. The housing **54** has a hollow interior sized and shaped for receiving a fan-driven generator assembly (generally designated by **56**), a lighting assembly (generally designated by **58**), and a lens assembly (generally designated by **60**). A generally rectangular opening **62** is provided adjacent to a downstream end (i.e., farthest from the tool assembly **16**) of each housing shell **50**, **52** for receiving the detent clips **32** extending from the collar **30** of the connector assembly **24** to releasably connect the hose assembly **12** to the housing **54**. A cylindrical receiver opening **64** extends inward into the downstream end of the housing **54**. The receiver opening **64** is sized and shaped for receiving the tubular fitting **34** of the connector assembly **24**. As will be appreciated, the hose assembly **12** and light assembly **14** are joined by inserting the tubular fitting **34** into the receiver opening **64** and pushing the collar **30** against the housing **54** while deflecting the detent clips inward and aligning them with the rectangular openings **62** of the upper and lower housing shells **50**, **52**. Once aligned with the openings **62** the clips **32** resiliently move outward to engage the openings to keep the hose assembly **12** and light assembly **14** together. To separate the hose assembly **12** and light assembly **14**, a user presses the clips **32** inward until they disengage the openings **62** so the hose assembly and light assembly can be pulled apart. When the hose assembly **12** and light assembly **14** are joined, the seal ring **42** on the fitting **34** presses against an annular land **66** formed at an upstream end of the receiver opening **64** to pneumatically seal the components and prevent outside air from being drawn through the connection. Although the connector assembly **24** described in this description releasably connects the light assembly **14** to the hose assembly **12**, it is envisioned that alternative examples of the connector assembly may permanently join the light assembly and the hose assembly. In addition, it is envisioned that the connector assembly **24** may be part of the light assembly **14** and be configured to connect to a preexisting vacuum hose or wand accessory.

(11) As also shown in FIGS. **3** and **4**, the fan-driven generator assembly **56** comprises an orifice plate **70** having openings or orifices **72** sized to limit flow through the generator assembly to minimize air used to power the lighting assembly **58**. Although the orifices may have other sizes, the illustrated orifices **72** are sized to limit air flow to five cubic feet per minute so only a small percentage of air pulled through the self-powered light assembly **14** by the vacuum. By minimizing air used to power the light assembly **14**, suction is maintained upstream at the tool assembly **16**. The orifices **72** are positioned to pull air through a DC generator **74** mounted upstream from the orifice plate **70**. As will be appreciated by those skilled in the art, the DC generator **74** generates direct current when air is pulled across a bladed rotor or fan inside the generator. As the vacuum pulls air through the generator **74**, its bladed rotor rotates causing the generator to generate an electrical current. As should be appreciated, the DC generator **74** may be constructed from a DC fan. Rather than applying a direct current to the fan motor causing the motor to rotate a fan, air is moved (i.e., blown or drawn) across the fan to rotate the motor, causing it to act as a generator and produce direct current. A filter **78** and a grate or grating **80** are mounted on an inlet of the generator **74** to protect the fan from damage. Further, a cover **82** having an inlet port **84** is attached to the grate **80**. The electric current generated by the generator **74** is used to power the lighting assembly **58**.

(12) The lighting assembly **58** comprises a generally annular printed circuit board (PCB) or more broadly a circuit **90** having a plurality of light-emitting diodes (LEDs) or more broadly a light-emitting device **92** arranged in a circle about the PCB. As those skilled in the art will appreciate, it is envisioned that other types of light emitting devices may be used instead of the LEDs, including

incandescent, fluorescent, halogen, xenon, or other conventional light emitting elements. Although the illustrated PCB is annular and the LEDs are arranged in a circle, it is envisioned that these components may have other configurations. In the illustrated example, a photocell **94** is provided on the PCB **90** for detecting whether the surface being vacuumed is sufficiently illuminated without energizing the LEDs **92**. When the LEDs **92** are not lit, the electrical current produced by the generator assembly **56** may be directed to a battery **96** for storage. Although the battery may be located in other locations, the illustrated battery **96** is mounted on the circuit board **90**. The stored power may be used to power the LEDs **92** when suction is unavailable or to reduce power requirements when the generator **74** is operating. An opening **98** is provided in the lower shell housing **52** to accommodate the photocell **94**. The PCB **90** may also include a conventional manually operable switch (not shown) for selectively energizing the LEDs **92**. A hollow sleeve **100** mounted in the housing **54** extends through the PCB **90** to provide a smooth passageway inside the lighting assembly **58**. In addition to shielding components of the lighting assembly **58** from debris-filled air passing through the sleeve **100**, it is envisioned that the smooth passageway created by the sleeve may reduce aerodynamic losses that would otherwise result from air passing over the components of the lighting assembly. The illustrated sleeve **100** includes a flange **102** that rests against the annular land **66** in the housing **54** and held in position by the land and the seal ring **42** on the connector assembly **24**.

(13) The illustrated lens assembly **60** comprises a series of three lenses **110**, **112**, **114** mounted in grooves **116** provided in the upper and lower housing shells **50**, **52**. The illustrated lenses **110**, **112**, **114** are made from optically clear polycarbonate or other resin. Lens **110** is configured to direct light emitted by the LEDs **92** into a narrow ring on lens **112**. Lens **112** is a fractal lens configured to further focus and direct the light as needed to create a narrower, more concentrated ring of light on lens **114**, which is also a fractal lens. Lens **114** is configured to concentrate the light from lens **112** at a planar output surface **118**. In addition to focusing and directing light, the third lens **114** also includes a central aperture **120** that receives a portion of the tool assembly **16** as will be explained.

(14) In the illustrated example shown in FIG. 5, the first lens **110** is a toroidal concavo-convex lens, which spreads light entering the lens along an arc providing a bean-shaped light pattern. In some examples, the bean-shaped light patterns resulting from adjacent LEDs **92** may overlap circumferentially to provide a more constant flux distribution. Further, the concavo-convex cross-sectional shape of the first lens **110** may collimate light exiting the lens. The second lens **112** is a fractal lens, having an outer portion shaped differently than its inner portion. The inner portion of the second lens **112** is a flat lens having parallel faces so light enters through a planar face and exits through a parallel planar face. The outer portion of the second lens **112** is shaped so light enters through a toroidal skewed convex face that concentrates the light and directs it toward the same planar face that light exiting the inner portion passes. Thus, the second lens **112** concentrates light so it leaves the lens in a narrower ring pattern. In the illustrated example, the third lens **114** is also a fractal lens. Similar to the second lens **112**, the inner portion of the third lens **114** is formed as a flat lens so light entering the inner portion leaves at an angle equal to that at which it enters the lens. The outer portion of the third lens **114** has an annular prism shape that directs and concentrates light entering the outer portion toward the same planar face through which light exits when traveling through the inner portion of the third lens **114**. Thus, the third lens concentrates light still further into a narrow ring pattern corresponding to the light input surface **132** of the lit tool assembly **10**.

(15) Historically the determining the lens parameters needed to create the desired optics required lengthy mathematical computations and/or iterative experimentation, but today the parameters may be determined using optical design software. For example, the lenses and other optical characteristics (e.g., lens spacing) may be determined using optics design software such as PHOTOPIA™ optics design software in combination with computer-aided-design software such as RHINOCEROS®. PHOTOPIA optics design software is available from LTI Optics, LLC of

Westminster, Colorado RHINOCEROS is a federally registered trademark of TLM, Inc., a Washington corporation doing business as Robert McNeel & Associates in Seattle, Washington. In addition to lenses, it is envisioned that the optics may include reflectors (e.g., parabolic reflectors) and other optical elements (e.g., fiber optic bundles) to direct light. As will be appreciated, the lens assembly may have other numbers of lenses and lens having different shapes. For example, it is envisioned that the optics may have a GOBO projector design in which light travels through a collimator before passing through an image plate having an arcuate opening matching a desired arcuate portion of the input surface **132**. Alternatively, it is envisioned that the GOBO projector design may include an optical condenser between the LED and the image plate and an objective lens between the image plate and the light input surface **132**.

(16) The lit tool assembly **16** comprises a light pipe or transmitting body, generally designated by **130**, that directs light generated in the light assembly **16** from a light input surface **132** to a light emitting tip **134** adapted to direct light toward a surface being vacuumed. The body **130** includes a tubular connector **136** sized and shaped to be pressed through the aperture **120** in the third lens **114** to join the tool assembly **16** to the light assembly **14**. The mating surfaces are configured so the input surface **132** of the body **130** is aligned with the output surface **118** of the lens **114**. Thus, light transmitted through the lens **114** is directed into the input surface **132**. The tool assembly **16** also includes an over-molding or cover, generally designated by **140**, surrounding the body **130** to prevent light users seeing light transmitted through the body and improve light transmission through the body. In the illustrated example, the cover **140** has shaped openings **142** through which the body **130** is visible. The openings **142** may be configured to create an illuminated marking or marker (e.g., an illuminated logo, graphic, or other indicia) for providing information or an aesthetic design on the tool assembly **16**. The illustrated tool assembly **16** includes a circular opening **144** allowing light to be emitted so a user can visually confirm light is being transmitted to the body **130**. As will be appreciated, the cover **140** is shorter than the body **130** to expose the light emitting tip **134** of the body so light is able to pass through corresponding side portions of the body to illuminate a surface being vacuumed. In addition to the cover **140**, the body **130** may include surface coatings or treatments to improve light transmission through the body. It is envisioned that body **130** may have other surface treatments to improve light emission where the body is exposed. Although the illustrated tool assembly **16** is a crevice tool, those skilled in the art will appreciate that vacuum tools having other configurations may be modified to include provisions for lighting. Such other tools include brushes, floor tools, and wands, as well as other conventional vacuum attachments.

(17) Although the illustrated hose assembly **12** is of the type used with canister or upright vacuum cleaners, those skilled in the art will appreciate the lit tool end **10** may be adapted for use with a whole-house vacuum system. Those skilled in the art will appreciate that the lit tool end **10** has applicability to both commercial and residential vacuum cleaners, including shop vacuums and vacuum systems. Further, it is envisioned that the lit tool end **10** may include a conventional wand handle or wand extension instead of or in addition to the flexible hose assembly.

(18) Those skilled in the art should understand the generator assembly **56** may be located at positions along the airstream other than between the lit tool assembly **16** and the tool end **22** of the conduit **20**. For example, the generator assembly **56** may be positioned in the tool assembly **16**. More particularly, the generator assembly **56** may be positioned within a housing of a tool assembly. In addition, the generator assembly **56** may be used to power other vacuum subassemblies or devices. For example, the generator assembly may be used to power BLUETOOTH® or wi-fi equipment. BLUETOOTH is a federally registered trademark of Bluetooth SIG, Inc., a Delaware corporation having an office in Kirkland, Washington. Using the generator assembly to power other electrical or electronic devices is also contemplated.

(19) It should be noted that the generator assembly **56** may be used along airstreams regardless of their direction of flow. For example, the generator assembly **56** may be positioned along a hose

connected to a compressor. Further, the generator assembly 56 may be modified for use with different fluids. One modified assembly would be used along a pressurized water or hydraulic line. In the case of incompressible fluids, the fan would be optimized to be a turbine. For example, the generator (turbine) assembly could be positioned along a remote pipeline to generate power needed to power satellite communications to transmit operational information or fault indications to a distant control room.

(20) When introducing elements in this description and the claims, the articles “a”, “an”, “the”, and “said” are intended to indicate one or more of the elements. The terms “comprising”, “including”, and “having” are intended to be inclusive and indicate there may be additional elements other than the listed elements.

(21) As those skilled in the art could make various changes to the above constructions, products, and methods without departing from the intended scope of the description, all matter in the above description and accompanying drawings should be interpreted as illustrative and not in a limiting sense. The patentable scope of the disclosure is defined by the claims, and can include other constructions and methods that would occur to those skilled in the art. Such other constructions are intended to be within the scope of the claims if the structural elements of the constructions do not differ from the literal language of the claims, or if the constructions include equivalent structural elements having insubstantial differences from the literal languages of the claims.

(22) To the extent that the specification, including the claims and accompanying drawings, discloses any additional subject matter that is not within the scope of the claims below, the disclosures are not dedicated to the public and the right to file one or more applications to claims such additional disclosures is reserved.

Claims

1. An assemblage for use with a vacuum to remove dust and debris from a selected surface by drawing air through an interior passage of a conduit, said conduit having a length extending from a vacuum end to a tool end opposite the vacuum end, said assemblage comprising: a light assembly capable of connecting to the tool end of the conduit, the light assembly including: a housing having a hollow interior in fluid communication with the interior passage of the conduit when the light assembly is connected to the tool end of the conduit; a generator having a fan rotor, the generator generating an electrical current in response to the fan rotor turning, said generator being positioned in the housing to move air across the fan rotor thereby turning the fan rotor so the generator generates the electrical current when air is being drawn through the housing and the interior passage of the conduit; a circuit positioned in the housing operatively connected to the generator and a light emitting device, said circuit energizing the light emitting device to emit light energy in response to receiving the electrical current from the generator; and a lens mounted in the housing and aligned with the light emitting device for concentrating the light energy emitted by the light emitting device; and a tool assembly adapted to connect to the light assembly housing, said tool assembly having an interior passageway extending from a downstream port in fluid communication with the hollow interior of the housing when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly housing to an upstream opening through which air is drawn when removing dust and debris from the selected surface, said tool assembly including: a light transmitting body having an input surface and a light emitting tip opposite the input surface, the input surface being mounted adjacent to the lens when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly so light energy concentrated by the lens enters the light transmitting body through the input surface and is transmitted through the body to the light emitting tip; and a cover surrounding the light transmitting body to prevent light energy transmitted through the light transmitting body from being emitted through the cover; wherein the light assembly and the tool assembly are selectively separable.

2. An assemblage as set forth in claim 1, wherein: the circuit comprises a printed circuit board; and

the light emitting device comprises a light emitting diode.

3. An assemblage as set forth in claim 2, wherein: the printed circuit board has a central opening; said light emitting diode is a first light emitting diode; and the light assembly comprises a plurality of light emitting diodes arranged around the central opening of the printed circuit board including said first light emitting diode.
4. An assemblage as set forth in claim 3, wherein the lens has a central aperture aligned with the central opening in the printed circuit board.
5. An assemblage as set forth in claim 4, wherein: the lens is a first lens; the light assembly comprises a plurality of lenses including said first lens; and each lens in said plurality of lenses has a central aperture aligned with the central opening in the printed circuit board.
6. An assemblage as set forth in claim 4, wherein the light transmitting body has a tubular section defining at least a portion of the interior passageway.
7. An assemblage as set forth in claim 4, wherein the tool assembly is a crevice tool.
8. An assemblage as set forth in claim 1, wherein the light assembly further comprises a photocell operatively connected to the circuit to deenergize the light emitting device when ambient light exceeds a predetermined level.
9. An assemblage as set forth in claim 1, wherein the light assembly further comprises a switch operatively connected to the circuit to selectively control the light emitting device.
10. An assemblage as set forth in claim 1, wherein the cover of the tool assembly includes shaped openings to allow light energy to be emitted through the cover.
11. An assemblage as set forth in claim 1, in combination with the conduit.
12. An assemblage as set forth in claim 11, in combination with the vacuum.
13. An assemblage for use with a vacuum to remove dust and debris from a selected surface by drawing air through an interior passage of a flexible hose, said flexible hose having a length extending from a vacuum end to a tool end opposite the vacuum end, said assemblage comprising: a light assembly capable of connecting to the tool end of the flexible hose, the light assembly including: a housing having a hollow interior in fluid communication with the interior passage of the flexible hose when the light assembly is connected to the tool end of the flexible hose; a generator having a fan rotor, the generator generating an electrical current in response to the fan rotor turning, the fan rotor being aligned with an opening in the housing so air moving through the opening moves across the fan rotor thereby turning the fan rotor so the generator generates the electrical current when air is being drawn through the opening and the interior passage of the flexible hose; a circuit positioned in the housing operatively connected to the generator and a light emitting device, said circuit energizing the light emitting device to emit light energy in response to receiving the electrical current from the generator; and a lens mounted in the housing and aligned with the light emitting device for concentrating the light energy emitted by the light on an output surface of the lens; and a tool assembly adapted to connect to the light assembly housing, said tool assembly having an interior passageway extending from a downstream port in fluid communication with the hollow interior of the housing when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly housing to an upstream opening through which air is drawn when removing dust and debris from the selected surface, said tool assembly including: a light transmitting body having a tubular section defining at least a portion of the interior passageway, the light transmitting body having an input surface mounted adjacent to the output surface of the lens when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly so light energy passes from the output surface of the lens to the input surface of the light transmitting body and is transmitted through the tubular section of the light transmitting body; and a cover surrounding the light transmitting body assembly to prevent light energy transmitted through the light transmitting body from being emitted through the cover, the cover having a shaped opening to allow light energy to be emitted through the shaped opening.
14. An assemblage as set forth in claim 13, wherein the tool assembly is a crevice tool.
15. An assemblage for use with a vacuum to remove dust and debris from a selected surface by

drawing air through an interior passage of a flexible hose, said flexible hose having a length extending from a vacuum end to a tool end opposite the vacuum end, said assemblage comprising: a light assembly capable of connecting to the tool end of the flexible hose, the light assembly including: a housing having a hollow interior in fluid communication with the interior passage of the flexible hose when the light assembly is connected to the tool end of the flexible hose, the housing including an orifice extending from outside the housing to the hollow interior; a generator having a fan rotor, the generator generating an electrical current in response to the fan rotor turning, said fan rotor being in fluid communication with the orifice in the housing to move air across the fan rotor when air is being drawn through the housing, so the fan rotor rotates causing the generator to generate the electrical current; an annular printed circuit board having a central opening and a plurality of light emitting diodes spaced around the central opening, the printed circuit board being positioned in the housing and operatively connected to the generator and the plurality of light emitting diodes to energize the plurality of light emitting diodes to emit light energy in response to receiving the electrical current from the generator; and a series of lenses mounted in the housing, each lens of said series of lenses having a central aperture aligned with the central opening in the printed circuit board, so light energy emitted by the plurality of light emitting diodes is concentrated by the series of lenses on an output surface of said series of lenses; and a tool assembly adapted to connect to the light assembly housing, said tool assembly having an interior passageway extending from a downstream port in fluid communication with the hollow interior of the housing when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly housing to an upstream opening through which air is drawn when removing dust and debris from the selected surface, said tool assembly including: a light transmitting body having an input surface and a light emitting tip opposite the input surface, the input surface being mounted adjacent to the output surface of the series of lenses when the tool assembly is connected to the light assembly so light energy concentrated by the series of lens enters the light transmitting body through the input surface and is transmitted through the body to the light emitting tip; and a cover surrounding the light transmitting body to prevent light energy transmitted through the light transmitting body from being emitted through the cover.

16. An assemblage as set forth in claim 15, wherein the light transmitting body has a tubular section defining at least a portion of the interior passageway.

17. An assemblage as set forth in claim 16, wherein the cover of the tool assembly includes shaped openings to allow light energy to be emitted through the cover.

18. An assemblage as set forth in claim 15, wherein the cover of the tool assembly includes shaped openings to allow light energy to be emitted through the cover.

19. An assemblage as set forth in claim 15, wherein the tool assembly is a crevice tool.
